Jesse Wedewer

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[Link to Latest]

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Personal Information

Citizenship: USA

Placement Committee

Director of Ph.D. Placement: Kyle Jurado (kyle.jurado@duke.edu)
Administrator: Taylor Murray Scisco (phd-assistant@econ.duke.edu)

Education

Duke University — Durham, NC
Ph.D. in Economics — 2027 (expected)
– Committee: Laura Pilossoph (Chair), Gregor Jarosch, Peter Arcidiacono, and Michael Dinerstein

University of Idaho — Moscow, ID
B.A. in Economics and Mathematics — 2018

Research Interests

Primary: Labor Economics
Secondary: Macroeconomics

Job Market Paper

Intergenerational Mobility in the Value of a Job (with Natalia Khorunzhina and Runling Wu)

Abstract: Intergenerational mobility is usually measured in income, yet workers value job amenities as well as pay. We measure intergenerational mobility in the value of a job, which reflects both amenities and pay. Using a revealed preference approach, we infer the value of each job from voluntary moves between jobs. We embed this approach in a job ladder model in which workers differ in preferences and job opportunities. Weekly benefit records let us distinguish quits, which reveal preferences, from layoffs, which do not. In Danish administrative data on parents and their children, we document that there is 37% less intergenerational persistence in job value than in earnings: the rank-rank slope is 0.11 in job value and 0.18 in earnings. A key reason behind this gap is that the children of high-earning parents tend to hold jobs that pay more but have worse amenities. Evidence from surveys suggests that these jobs are more demanding: they involve greater competition, longer hours, and greater time pressure.

Working Papers

1. ***The Search Costs of Inflation in the Labor Market*** May 2026
with Laura Pilossoph and Jane Ryngaert Submitted

Abstract: This paper studies the effect of unanticipated inflation in the labor market. When wages are contracted in nominal terms, inflation reduces real wages, leading workers to intensify on-the-job search to obtain wage-adjusting outside offers. Both the search effort and the resulting job mobility are costly, yet that same mobility raises output by moving workers toward more productive matches. To quantify these costs and benefits, we extend the canonical job ladder of Postel-Vinay and Robin (2002) to a nominal environment with privately chosen search effort, and calibrate it to standard moments from the pre-pandemic US labor market. A one-time inflation shock scaled to the COVID episode generates an average welfare loss of 0.44% of consumption, with workers at the top of the wage distribution bearing losses over six times those at the bottom. Once the offsetting transfer of surplus to firms and productivity gains from reallocation are accounted for, the net aggregate cost is close to zero. Second, inflation volatility imposes asymmetric costs: worker welfare is approximately invariant to the volatility regime because firms compensate workers for expected search costs at hiring, but social welfare declines meaningfully because the resource cost of search effort is not undone by compensation. This second finding identifies a distinct, labor-market source of welfare costs from inflation volatility, complementing the price-dispersion costs emphasized in the New Keynesian literature.

2. ***The Worker and Firm Origins of Life-Cycle Wage Inequality*** September 2026
with Xincheng Qiu and Runling Wu Submitted

Abstract: Wage inequality widens substantially over the life cycle. We decompose this widening into worker and firm heterogeneity in returns to experience and sorting. We generalize the AKM model to allow wage growth to differ across workers and firms and develop a two-way clustering algorithm for estimation. Using Italian matched employer-employee data, we document substantial heterogeneity in both worker and firm growth effects. Worker growth accounts for two-thirds of the rise in life-cycle wage inequality, while firm growth accounts for the remaining third. Workers with more accumulated skills increasingly sort into high-paying firms over the life cycle.

Other Research

Text Sentiment about Monetary Policy November 2025
with Hie Joo Ahn, Thomas R. Cook, Taeyoung Doh, and Elias Kastritis

Employment

Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta Atlanta, GA
PhD Summer Intern 2026

Federal Reserve Bank of Cleveland Cleveland, OH
Summer Economics Fellow 2024

Federal Reserve Board of Governors Washington, DC
Research Assistant, Labor Market Section 2018–2021

Research Experience

Duke University Durham, NC
Graduate Assistant for Laura Pilossoph 2023–present
Research Assistant, Baby's First Years 2022

Teaching Experience

Duke University Durham, NC

Teaching Assistant

Intermediate Microeconomics (Econ 201)	Fall 2024
Principles of Economics (Econ 101)	Spring 2023
Statistical Foundations of Econometrics (Econ 104)	Fall 2022

Honors, Scholarships, and Fellowships

Duke Graduate School Summer Research Fellowship	2026
Departmental Summer Research Fellowship, Duke University	2025, 2024, 2023
AEA Summer Fellowship, Federal Reserve Bank of Cleveland	2024
Outstanding Senior in Economics, University of Idaho	2018
AEA Summer Training and Scholarship Program, Michigan State University	2017

Seminars and Conference Presentations

2026: Society of Labor Economists Annual Meeting (Denver), Search and Matching Conference (Amsterdam), Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta

2025: Search and Matching Conference (Lithuania), Society for Economic Dynamics Annual Meeting (Copenhagen)

2024: Federal Reserve Bank of Cleveland

Service

Co-organizer, The Micro and Macro Perspective of the Labor Market Reading Group	2023–present
Duke Economics Student Labor/Public Workshop	2023
Duke Economics Graduate Mentorship Program (GMP)	2023

Skills and Languages

Skills: Stata, Python, R, MATLAB, Julia, LaTeX
Languages: English (Native)

References

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